

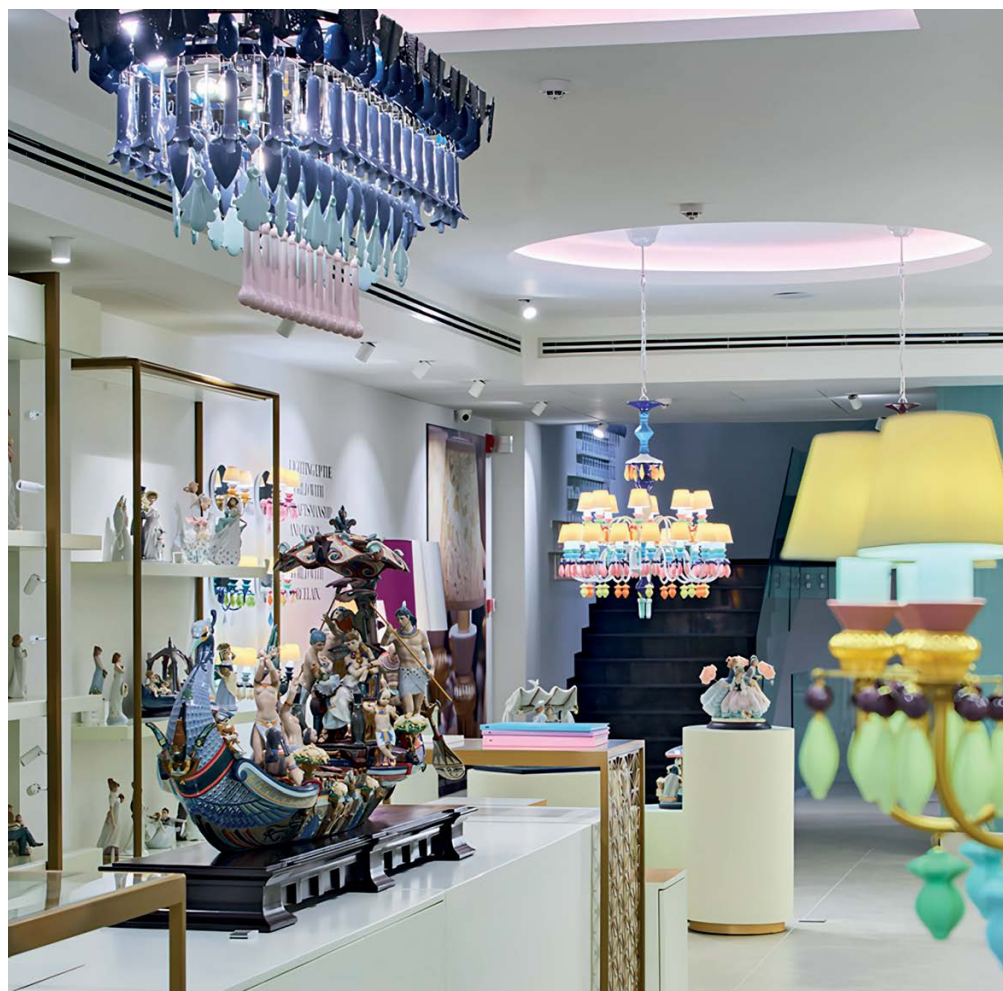
is a Hindu population. It is particularly popular in the US,” says Rodriguez.

As part of Lladró’s strategy, whenever they enter a new market, they launch a collection specific to that market to connect with the local tastes and traditions. “It is in our DNA. A lot of our success has to do with the way customers emotionally connect with our pieces. Globally, our bestsellers are on themes like mother and child, maternity—universal feelings that anyone can identify with,” she says.

These are the reasons Lladró sustained its business in India with a 1.5 per cent growth in India even in 2020, when the world had come to a standstill during the pandemic. It bounced back in 2021, with a 43 per cent jump in sales over the previous year. Between January and August 2022, Lladró’s business in India grew by 47 per cent compared to the same period in 2021, marking it as the brand’s most successful period. The year 2022 also saw a large number of new customers, who contributed to 50 per cent of the total sales.

S INDIA CONTINUES to be a key market for the brand, Rodriguez says it will open more mono-brand stores in Delhi, Mumbai and Bengaluru. “We have extensive expansion plans and we want the brand to be better known among the young people.”

Rodriguez adds that online sales are also becoming important for the company. Globally, 15 per cent of its revenues currently come from online, and it plans to increase that to 25 per cent over the next 5-6 years. “Currently, our online



▲ **WARM VIBES** Spread over 475 sq. m, Lladró’s new store in Delhi is the second largest in the world

presence in India is very limited, less than 5 per cent, but we are investing in it and expanding it starting next year.”

The general impression, Rodriguez says, is that porcelain is delicate and should not be bought online as there is fear of breakage. “Porcelain is not that fragile, and our packaging involves a lot of engineering to ensure that there is no breakage. During the pandemic, people started buying online, and once they realised that there is no breakage, the trend has continued. It’s extremely important for our growth, so we will strengthen it,” she explains.

The opening of the New Delhi store is part of Lladró’s broader expansion strategy in India and Asia. Over the past two years, the brand has opened new stores in key markets, including China, South Korea, Indonesia, Malaysia, Nepal and Thailand. This expansion is aligned with the company’s omni-channel strategy that focusses on strengthening both digital sales channels and physical points of sale.

As more and more Indians become home buyers, Lladró hopes to corner a larger share of their home décor budget. Who knows, the next time you visit a house-warming party, you just might see a Spanish-made Ganesha smiling at you. **BT**

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